

Local Coverage Determination (LCD)

Suction Pumps

L33612

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Contractor Information

Contractor Name	Contract Type	Contract Number	Jurisdiction	States
CGS Administrators, LLC	DME MAC	17013 - DME MAC	J-B	Illinois Indiana Kentucky Michigan Minnesota Ohio Wisconsin
CGS Administrators, LLC	DME MAC	18003 - DME MAC	J-C	Alabama Arkansas Colorado Florida Georgia Louisiana Mississippi New Mexico North Carolina Oklahoma Puerto Rico South Carolina Tennessee Texas Virgin Islands

Contractor Name	Contract Type	Contract Number	Jurisdiction	States
				Virginia West Virginia
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	DME MAC	16013 - DME MAC	J-A	Connecticut Delaware District of Columbia Maine Maryland Massachusetts New Hampshire New Jersey New York - Entire State Pennsylvania Rhode Island Vermont
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	DME MAC	19003 - DME MAC	J-D	Alaska American Samoa Arizona California - Entire State Guam Hawaii Idaho Iowa Kansas Missouri - Entire State Montana Nebraska Nevada North Dakota Northern Mariana Islands

6/15/26, 6:32 PMLCD - Suction Pumps (L33612)

Contractor Name	Contract Type	Contract Number	Jurisdiction	States
				Oregon South Dakota Utah Washington Wyoming

LCD Information

Document Information

LCD ID
L33612

LCD Title
Suction Pumps

Proposed LCD in Comment Period
N/A

Source Proposed LCD
N/A

Original Effective Date
For services performed on or after 10/01/2015

Revision Effective Date
For services performed on or after 01/01/2024

Revision Ending Date
N/A

Retirement Date
N/A

Notice Period Start Date
N/A

Notice Period End Date
N/A

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Issue

Issue Description

The LCD is revised to align refill requirements with CMS Final Rule CMS-1780-F. This revision allows contact with the beneficiary regarding refills to take place no sooner than 30 calendar days prior to the end of the current supply and to document an affirmative response.

Issue - Explanation of Change Between Proposed LCD and Final LCD

No proposed LCD issued.

CMS National Coverage Policy

CMS Manual System, Pub. 100.03, Medicare National Coverage Determinations Manual, Chapter 1, Section 280-1

Coverage Guidance

Coverage Indications, Limitations, and/or Medical Necessity

For any item to be covered by Medicare, it must 1) be eligible for a defined Medicare benefit category, 2) be reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis or treatment of illness or injury

or to improve the functioning of a malformed body member, and 3) meet all other applicable Medicare statutory and regulatory requirements.

The purpose of a Local Coverage Determination (LCD) is to provide information regarding “reasonable and necessary” criteria based on Social Security Act § 1862(a)(1)(A) provisions.

In addition to the “reasonable and necessary” criteria contained in this LCD there are other payment rules, which are discussed in the following documents, that must also be met prior to Medicare reimbursement:

- The LCD-related Standard Documentation Requirements Article, located at the bottom of this policy under the Related Local Coverage Documents section.
- The LCD-related Policy Article, located at the bottom of this policy under the Related Local Coverage Documents section. Refer to the related Local Coverage Policy Article for Suction Pumps for additional information about the statutory requirements for payment and information about correct coding.
- Refer to the Supplier Manual for additional information on documentation requirements.
- Refer to the DME MAC web sites for additional bulletin articles and other publications related to this LCD.

For the items addressed in this LCD, the “reasonable and necessary” criteria, based on Social Security Act § 1862(a)(1)(A) provisions, are defined by the following coverage indications, limitations and/or medical necessity.

GASTRIC SUCTION

A gastric suction pump (E2000) is used to remove gastrointestinal fluids under continuous or intermittent suction via a tube. Use of a gastric suction pump and related supplies are covered for beneficiaries who are unable to empty gastric secretions through normal gastrointestinal functions. Use of a gastric suction pump for other conditions will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Supplies (tubing, tape, dressings, etc.) are covered and are separately payable when they are medically necessary and used with a medically necessary E2000 pump. Supplies used with DME that is denied as not reasonable and necessary will also be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

RESPIRATORY SUCTION

A respiratory suction pump (E0600) is only covered for beneficiaries who have difficulty raising and clearing secretions secondary to:

1. Cancer or surgery of the throat or mouth
2. Dysfunction of the swallowing muscles

3. Unconsciousness or obtunded state

4. Tracheostomy

Use of a respiratory suction pump for other conditions will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Suction catheters (A4605, A4624, A4628) and sterile water/saline (A4216, A4217) are covered and are separately payable when they are medically necessary and used with a medically necessary E0600 pump. Supplies used with DME that is denied as not reasonable and necessary will also be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Codes A4605 and A4624 are only covered for beneficiaries with a tracheostomy. Refer to the ICD-10 code list in the LCD-related Policy Article for applicable diagnoses.

- Tracheal suction catheters (A4624) are reasonable and necessary only when all of the following are met:
 - The beneficiary has a tracheostomy.
 - The beneficiary requires the use of a covered respiratory suction pump (E0600) as described above, for tracheostomy suctioning.
- Closed system catheters (A4605) are reasonable and necessary only when all of the following are met:
 - The beneficiary has a tracheostomy.
 - The beneficiary requires the use of a covered respiratory suction pump (E0600) as described above, for tracheostomy suctioning.
 - The beneficiary requires the use of a covered ventilator. (Refer to CMS' Internet Only Manual 100-03, CH 1, §280.1 for information about the coverage of ventilators.)

Claims for A4605 and A4624 suction catheters that do not meet all of the criteria above will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

More than three A4624 catheters per day will be denied as not reasonable and necessary for tracheostomy suctioning.

Non-tracheal suction catheters (A4628) are reasonable and necessary for suctioning in the oropharynx. The oropharynx is not sterile, therefore the catheter can be reused if properly cleansed and/or disinfected. More than three catheters (A4628) per week will be denied as not reasonable and necessary for oropharyngeal suctioning.

A7047 is not used to remove secretions for the covered indications described above. Claims for A7047 will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Sterile water/saline solution (A4216, A4217) is covered when used to clear a suction catheter after tracheostomy suctioning. Sterile water/saline will be denied as not reasonable

and necessary when used for oropharyngeal suctioning.

WOUND SUCTION

Use of suction on wounds (A9272, K0743) is only appropriate in those clinical scenarios where the quantity of exudate exceeds the capacity of conservative measures such as surgical dressings and wound fillers to contain it. However, wound suction to remove exudate can be accomplished with the use of non-covered disposable, suction devices (A9272) or with covered DME devices (K0743). When a non-covered alternative exists (A9272), it is not reasonable or necessary to use a covered DME item (K0743). Therefore, when K0743 is billed it will be denied as not reasonable and necessary. Refer to the related Local Coverage Policy Article for Suction Pumps for additional information about the statutory requirements for disposable wound suction items (A9270, A9272).

Wound suction pumps and their associated supplies, which have not been specifically designated as being qualified to use HCPCS code K0743 via written instructions from the Pricing, Data Analysis and Coding (PDAC) Contractor will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Supplies (dressings, tubing, etc.) are covered and are separately payable when they are medically necessary and used with a medically necessary K0743 pump. Supplies used with DME that is denied as not reasonable and necessary will also be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

GENERAL

A Standard Written Order (SWO) must be communicated to the supplier before a claim is submitted. If the supplier bills for an item addressed in this policy without first receiving a completed SWO, the claim shall be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

For Durable Medical Equipment, Prosthetics, Orthotics and Supplies (DMEPOS) base items that require a Written Order Prior to Delivery (WOPD), the supplier must have received a signed SWO before the DMEPOS item is delivered to a beneficiary. If a supplier delivers a DMEPOS item without first receiving a WOPD, the claim shall be denied as not reasonable and necessary. Refer to the LCD-related Policy Article, located at the bottom of this policy under the Related Local Coverage Documents section.

For DMEPOS base items that require a WOPD, and also require separately billed associated options, accessories, and/or supplies, the supplier must have received a WOPD which lists the base item and which may list all the associated options, accessories, and/or supplies that are separately billed prior to the delivery of the items. In this scenario, if the supplier separately bills for associated options, accessories, and/or supplies without first receiving a

completed and signed WOPD of the base item prior to delivery, the claim(s) shall be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

An item/service is correctly coded when it meets all the coding guidelines listed in CMS HCPCS guidelines, LCDs, LCD-related Policy Articles, or DME MAC articles. Claims that do not meet coding guidelines shall be denied as not reasonable and necessary/incorrectly coded.

Proof of delivery (POD) is a Supplier Standard and DMEPOS suppliers are required to maintain POD documentation in their files. Proof of delivery documentation must be made available to the Medicare contractor upon request. All services that do not have appropriate proof of delivery from the supplier shall be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

REFILL REQUIREMENTS

For DMEPOS items and supplies provided on a recurring basis, billing must be based on prospective, not retrospective use. For DMEPOS products that are supplied as refills to the original order, suppliers must contact the beneficiary, and document an affirmative response, prior to dispensing the refill and not automatically ship on a pre-determined basis, even if authorized by the beneficiary. This shall be done to ensure that the refilled item remains reasonable and necessary, existing supplies are expected to end, and to confirm any changes or modifications to the order. Contact with the beneficiary or designee regarding refills must take place no sooner than 30 calendar days prior to the expected end of the current supply. For delivery of refills, the supplier must deliver the DMEPOS product no sooner than 10 calendar days prior to the expected end of the current supply. This is regardless of which delivery method is utilized.

For all DMEPOS items that are provided on a recurring basis, suppliers are required to have contact with the beneficiary or caregiver/designee and document an affirmative response, prior to dispensing a new supply of items. Suppliers must not deliver refills without a refill request and an affirmative response from a beneficiary. Items delivered without a valid, documented refill request will be denied as not reasonable and necessary.

Suppliers must not dispense a quantity of supplies exceeding a beneficiary's expected utilization. Suppliers must stay attuned to changed or atypical utilization patterns on the part of their clients. Suppliers must verify with the treating practitioners that any changed or atypical utilization is warranted.

Regardless of utilization, a supplier must not dispense more than a 3-month quantity at a time.

Summary of Evidence

NA

Analysis of Evidence (Rationale for Determination)

NA

Coding Information

CPT/HCPCS Codes

Group 1 (16 Codes)

Group 1 Paragraph

The appearance of a code in this section does not necessarily indicate coverage.

HCPCS MODIFIERS:

EY - No physician or other licensed health care provider order for this item or service

HCPCS CODES:

Group 1 Codes

Code	Description
A4216	STERILE WATER, SALINE AND/OR DEXTROSE, DILUENT/FLUSH, 10 ML
A4217	STERILE WATER/SALINE, 500 ML
A4605	TRACHEAL SUCTION CATHETER, CLOSED SYSTEM, EACH
A4624	TRACHEAL SUCTION CATHETER, ANY TYPE OTHER THAN CLOSED SYSTEM, EACH
A4628	ORAL AND/OR OROPHARYNGEAL SUCTION CATHETER, EACH

Code	Description
A7000	CANISTER, DISPOSABLE, USED WITH SUCTION PUMP, EACH
A7001	CANISTER, NON-DISPOSABLE, USED WITH SUCTION PUMP, EACH
A7002	TUBING, USED WITH SUCTION PUMP, EACH
A7047	ORAL INTERFACE USED WITH RESPIRATORY SUCTION PUMP, EACH
A9272	WOUND SUCTION, DISPOSABLE, INCLUDES DRESSING, ALL ACCESSORIES AND COMPONENTS, ANY TYPE, EACH
E0600	RESPIRATORY SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE OR STATIONARY, ELECTRIC
E2000	GASTRIC SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE OR STATIONARY, ELECTRIC
K0743	SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE, FOR USE ON WOUNDS
K0744	ABSORPTIVE WOUND DRESSING FOR USE WITH SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE, PAD SIZE 16 SQUARE INCHES OR LESS
K0745	ABSORPTIVE WOUND DRESSING FOR USE WITH SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE, PAD SIZE MORE THAN 16 SQUARE INCHES BUT LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO 48 SQUARE INCHES
K0746	ABSORPTIVE WOUND DRESSING FOR USE WITH SUCTION PUMP, HOME MODEL, PORTABLE, PAD SIZE GREATER THAN 48 SQUARE INCHES

General Information

Associated Information

DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Section 1833(e) of the Social Security Act precludes payment to any provider of services unless "there has been furnished such information as may be necessary in order to determine the amounts due such provider." It is expected that the beneficiary's medical records will reflect the need for the care provided. The beneficiary's medical records include the treating practitioner's office records, hospital records, nursing home records, home health agency records, records from other healthcare professionals and test reports. This documentation must be available upon request.

GENERAL DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

In order to justify payment for DMEPOS items, suppliers must meet the following requirements:

- SWO
- Medical Record Information (including continued need/use if applicable)
- Correct Coding
- Proof of Delivery

Refer to the LCD-related Standard Documentation Requirements article, located at the bottom of this policy under the Related Local Coverage Documents section for additional information regarding these requirements.

Refer to the Supplier Manual for additional information on documentation requirements.

Refer to the DME MAC web sites for additional bulletin articles and other publications related to this LCD.

POLICY SPECIFIC DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Items covered in this LCD have additional policy-specific requirements that must be met prior to Medicare reimbursement.

Refer to the LCD-related Policy article, located at the bottom of this policy under the Related Local Coverage Documents section for additional information.

Miscellaneous

Appendices

Utilization Guidelines

Refer to Coverage Indications, Limitations and/or Medical Necessity

Sources of Information

CR 7411
NCD 280.14

Bibliography

NA

Revision History Information

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
01/01/2024	R7	Revision Effective Date: 01/01/2024 COVERAGE INDICATIONS, LIMITATIONS, AND/OR MEDICAL NECESSITY: Added: “and document an affirmative response” to language that pertains to contact with the beneficiary or caregiver/designee for DMEPOS products supplied as refills Revised: “approaching exhaustion” to “expected to end” in regard to existing supplies Revised: “Contact with the beneficiary or designee regarding refills must take place no sooner than 14	• Provider Education/Guidance • Other (CMS Final Rule CMS-1780-F)

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		calendar days prior to the delivery/shipping date.” to “Contact with the beneficiary or designee regarding refills must take place no sooner than 30 calendar days prior to the expected end of the current supply.” Revised: “For delivery of refills, the supplier must deliver the DMEPOS product no sooner than 10 calendar days prior to the end of usage for the current product.” to “For delivery of refills, the supplier must deliver the DMEPOS product no sooner than 10 calendar days prior to the expected end of the current supply.” <i>12/14/2023: Pursuant to the 21st Century Cures Act, these revisions do not require notice and comment because the revisions are non-discretionary updates to refill requirement information per CMS Final Rule CMS-1780-F.</i>	

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
04/01/2023	R6	Revision Effective Date: 04/01/2023 HCPCS CODES: Revised: Long descriptor for HCPCS code A4628 <i>04/13/2023: Pursuant to the 21st Century Cures Act, these revisions do not require notice and comment because they are non-discretionary updates to CMS HCPCS coding determinations.</i>	• Revisions Due To CPT/HCPCS Code Changes
01/01/2020	R5	Revision Effective Date: 01/01/2020 COVERAGE INDICATIONS, LIMITATIONS, AND/OR MEDICAL NECESSITY: Removed: Statement to refer to ICD-10 Codes that are Covered section in the LCD-related PA Added: Statement to refer to ICD-10 code list in the LCD-related Policy Article GENERAL: Revised: Order information as a result of Final Rule 1713 REFILL REQUIREMENTS: Revised: “ordering physicians” to “treating practitioners” CODING INFORMATION:	• Provider Education/Guidance • Other

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		Removed: Field titled "Bill Type" Removed: Field titled "Revenue Codes" Removed: Field titled "ICD-10 Codes that Support Medical Necessity" Removed: Field titled "ICD-10 Codes that DO NOT Support Medical Necessity" Removed: Field titled "Additional ICD-10 Information" DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS: Revised: "physician's" to "treating practitioner's" GENERAL DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS: Revised: "Prescriptions (orders)" to "SWO" <i>02/20/2020: Pursuant to the 21st Century Cures Act, these revisions do not require notice and comment because they are due to non-discretionary coverage updates reflective of CMS FR-1713.</i>	

01/01/2019

R4

Revision Effective Date:
01/01/2019

- Other (ICD-10 code relocation per CMS

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		COVERAGE INDICATIONS, LIMITATIONS, AND/OR MEDICAL NECESSITY: Removed: Statement to refer to diagnosis code section below Added: Refer to Covered ICD-10 Codes in the LCD-related Policy Article ICD-10 CODES THAT SUPPORT MEDICAL NECESSITY: Moved: All diagnosis codes to the LCD-related Policy Article diagnosis code section per CMS instruction ICD-10 CODES THAT DO NOT SUPPORT MEDICAL NECESSITY: Moved: Statement about noncovered diagnosis codes moved to LCD-related Policy Article noncovered diagnosis code section per CMS instruction	instruction)
01/01/2017	R3	Revision Effective Date: 01/01/2017 COVERAGE INDICATIONS, INDICATIONS, LIMITATIONS AND/OR MEDICAL NECESSITY: Removed: Standard	Provider Education/Guidance

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		Documentation Language Added: New reference language and directions to Standard Documentation Requirements Added: General Requirements Revised: Refill Requirements DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS: Removed: Standard Documentation Language Added: General Documentation Requirements Added: New reference language and directions to Standard Documentation Requirements POLICY SPECIFIC DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS: Removed: Standard Documentation Language Added: Direction to Standard Documentation Requirements Removed: Supplier Manual reference under Miscellaneous Removed: PIM citation under Appendices RELATED LOCAL COVERAGE DOCUMENTS: Added: LCD-related	

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		Standard Documentation Requirements article	
07/01/2016	R2	Effective July 1, 2016 oversight for DME MAC LCDs is the responsibility of CGS Administrators, LLC 18003 and 17013 and Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC 19003 and 16013. No other changes have been made to the LCDs.	Change in Assigned States or Affiliated Contract Numbers
10/01/2015	R1	Revision Effective Date: 10/31/2014 COVERAGE INDICATIONS, LIMITATIONS AND/OR MEDICAL NECESSITY: Revised: Standard Documentation Language to add covered prior to a beneficiary's Medicare eligibility Revised: Diagnosis code references DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS: Revised: Standard Documentation Language to add who can enter date of delivery date on the POD Added: Instructions for Equipment Retained from	Provider Education/Guidance

Revision History Date	Revision History Number	Revision History Explanation	Reasons for Change
		a Prior Payer Added: Repair/Replacement section Revised: Diagnosis code references	

Associated Documents

Attachments

N/A

Related Local Coverage Documents

Articles

- A55426 - Standard Documentation Requirements for All Claims Submitted to DME MACs [↗](#)
- A52519 - Suction Pumps - Policy Article [↗](#)

Related National Coverage Documents

NCDs

- 280.1 - Durable Medical Equipment Reference List [↗](#)

Public Versions

Updated On	Effective Dates	Status	
12/07/2023	01/01/2024 - N/A	Currently in Effect	You are here

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Keywords

N/A